



Breezy, cold 25/7 • Tomorrow: Cloudy, cold 22/10 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

THURSDAY, JANUARY 29, 2026 • \$4



LEFT: Vika, who is accused of trying to plant a bomb near a police station in Mykolaiv, Ukraine, when she was 18, stands next to her brother Ihor, who served in the Ukrainian military. **RIGHT:** A crumpled sign for the southern Ukrainian port city is seen in October.



CAROLYN VAN HOUTEN/THE WASHINGTON POST

As Trump pivots for calm in Minn., his base bristles

HARD-LINERS URGE NO LETUP IN ROUNDUPS

President pulled both ways as policies lose support

BY NATALIE ALLISON, ISAAC ARNSDORF AND HANNAH KNOWLES

President Donald Trump's efforts this week to "de-escalate" controversial deportation tactics in Minnesota in the face of widespread public dismay has caused a new wave of blowback from his base of hardline anti-immigration advocates.

The president is caught between competing interests: a loyal base of voters who elected him on a campaign promise of "mass deportations" and a broader electorate that is increasingly uncomfortable with an aggressive ap-

proach that has led to the shooting deaths of two American protesters by federal agents this month.

The conflicting viewpoints are evident within the administration, too, with advisers divided along similar lines and offering opposing feedback on whether and how drastically to shift Trump's immigration strategy, according to people aware of the conversations.

And Trump is navigating a collision of his own instincts: his desire for flashy roundups of foreign-born criminals, and his recognition that the broader public,

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Protesters charged: DOJ accuses 16 of assault and interference. **A3**

Rep. Omar attacked: The FBI is probing the town hall incident. **A4**

Rubio: U.S. not planning another Venezuela strike

But in appearance before lawmakers, he declines to rule out military action

BY NOAH ROBERTSON

Secretary of State Marco Rubio said Wednesday that the United States was not in a "state of war" with Venezuela and that the Trump administration does not "intend" to take further military action there, tempering previous threats to again use lethal force unless the interim government in Caracas grants Washington unfettered access to its oil industry and expels U.S. adversaries, including Russia, Iran and China.

Rubio's comments came during a contentious hearing before the

Senate Foreign Relations Committee, as lawmakers from both parties criticized the administration for withholding information from Congress ahead of the U.S. military's deadly raid to apprehend Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro.

Rubio, who also serves as the White House national security adviser, sought to reassure them that the administration would consult with Congress ahead of any sustained military action in the future, and he pushed back on accusations that he and other Trump officials misled lawmakers before the stunning snatch-and-grab mission Jan. 3.

"I can tell you right now with full certainty, we are not postured to — nor do we intend or expect to — have to take any military action in Venezuela at any time," Rubio

SEE **RUBIO** ON **A13**

Government moves to sell former site of Trump hotel

BY OLIVIA GEORGE AND JONATHAN O'CONNELL

The Trump administration is preparing to sell the Old Post Office, a 19th-century landmark in the heart of D.C. that previously housed one of the president's luxury hotels, according to records obtained by The Washington Post.

Officials are moving to sell the property to the bank that controls the long-term lease as "part of ongoing efforts to reduce the federal government's footprint," according to a letter sent to the city's State Historic Preservation Office last month.

On Pennsylvania Avenue between the White House and the Capitol, the building is now home to a Waldorf Astoria hotel. For many, though, it remains synonymous with the previous tenant: The Trump International Hotel, which opened nearly in lockstep with Trump's 2016 election and served as a clubhouse of sorts during his first term. Lobbyists dined in the steakhouse. Supporters made pilgrimages to the bar.

SEE **BUILDING** ON **A8**

When relics and memories are all that remain

A year after the Potomac plane crash, families and first responders reflect on tragedy and recovery

BY EMMA UBER

The brown teddy bear smelled like oil and jet fuel.

It was tucked inside the pink backpack of 11-year-old Alydia Livingston, along with her headphones, journal and a pencil topped with a rubber unicorn. The backpack and its contents came home to her grandparents in Richmond. Alydia didn't.

The girl, her 14-year-old sister, Everly, and parents Donna and Peter were aboard American Eagle Flight 5342, the plane clipped by an Army helicopter over the Potomac River as it prepared to land at Reagan National Airport. No one in either aircraft survived.

In the weeks and months after the crash that killed 67 people, small personal treasures retrieved from the water would find their way to the places where they held meaning. A man's wedding ring discovered as a diver sifted through sand at the bottom of the river. A phone that still worked, showing Asra Hussain's last moments were spent planning a dinner party for her friends. A note Jesse Pitcher's wife slipped into his suitcase like she did like every time he went away, this one en-

SEE **DCA** ON **A2**



MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

"I can still feel it in the back of my throat, the smell of jet fuel," D.C. officer Tim Ochenschlager said.

Layoffs up, hiring down as Amazon's cuts resound

BY CAROLINE O'DONOVAN AND DANIELLE ABRIL

Job cuts and other changes at Amazon, the country's second-largest private employer, rippled through the economy this week, throwing workers at the company and some of its partners into a tough job market.

On Wednesday morning, thousands of corporate employees at the online retailer learned they will lose their jobs, part of ongoing layoffs first announced in October.

The day before, Amazon said it would shutter its Amazon Fresh grocery stores, laying off retail workers across dozens of stores. That same day, UPS said that it would be slashing 30,000 delivery jobs this year in part because of Amazon sending it less business.

The layoffs and closures underscore weak points in an economy that is doing well by some measures but in which workers face a tough job market that made 2025 the second-worst year

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Alex Pretti's killing Policing experts said the situation probably could have been avoided with basic tactics that prioritize public safety and communication. **A6**

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A White biologist sued Cornell University, alleging it used race-based hiring practices. **A8**
Three brothers are accused of raping women and girls they lured with trips and parties. **A8**

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"Heated Rivalry," the hit show, has been a boon to the NHL. But its popularity has also raised questions of inclusion for the league. **B7**

THE REGION
A viral video has reignited concerns about "inhumane conditions" at a federal immigration facility in Baltimore. **B13**
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Learn how "aspirational clutter" — born of the gap between who we are and who we want to be — affects our homes.

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The Washington Post
Year 149, No. 54476

